

Miao Li

Postdoctoral Researcher in NLP/AI
School of Informatics, The University of Edinburgh

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WORKING EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Researcher, The University of Edinburgh
Institute for Language, Cognition and Computation
Supervised by Prof. [Mirella Lapata](#)

Mar. 2025 – Present

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

Visiting Ph.D. The University of Edinburgh
Institute for Language, Cognition and Computation
Advised by Prof. [Mirella Lapata](#)

Mar. 2024 – Mar. 2025

Ph.D. The University of Melbourne
School of Computing and Information Systems
Advised by Prof. [Eduard Hovy](#) and Prof. [Jey Han Lau](#)

Dec. 2020 – Mar. 2025

M.Sc. (Exam-exempt Postgraduate) Chinese Academy of Sciences
Institute of Software, Chinese Academy of Sciences

Aug. 2017 – July 2020

B.S. Northeastern University
School of Computer Science and Technology

Aug. 2013 – July 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Multi-document understanding: Enabling computers to reason over and synthesize dispersed information from multiple documents, e.g., summarizing or synthesizing insights from multiple scientific articles
- Long-context reasoning: Building advanced long-context foundation models and autonomous agents, that can effectively correlate and integrate voluminous, heterogeneous, and distributed information
- Language model post-training: Developing effective and efficient post-training techniques to push the limits of large language models (LLMs), especially on reasoning tasks over complex contexts
- Language model evaluation: Establishing controlled experimentation and rigorous evaluation methodologies to assess not only language model outputs but also their inner workings and behaviors to understand their real-world capabilities

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Proficient with problem formulation, large-scale data curation, modelling and evaluation methodologies for advanced natural language reasoning and generation tasks
- Experienced in post-training and experimenting with large language models (LLMs), especially for tasks involving long and complex contexts
- Familiar with programming in Python and PyTorch, and utilizing frameworks for LLMs (e.g., Transformers and Accelerate)
- Solid understanding of natural language processing (NLP), deep learning and fundamental statistical machine learning

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

- [Who Gets Cited Most? Benchmarking Long-Context Reasoning on Scientific Articles](#) arXiv'25
Miao Li, Alexander Gurung, Irina Saparina, and Mirella Lapata.
Preprint (September 2025).
- [Long-Context Reasoning Through Proxy-Based Chain-of-Thought Tuning](#) ACL'26
Miao Li, Irina Saparina, Alexander Gurung, and Mirella Lapata.
Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics
- [Decomposed Opinion Summarization with Verified Aspect-Aware Modules](#) ACL'25
Miao Li, Jey Han Lau, Eduard Hovy, Mirella Lapata
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2025.

- [NewsBench: A Systematic Evaluation Framework for Assessing Editorial Capabilities of Large Language Models in Chinese Journalism](#) ACL'24
Miao Li, Ming-Bin Chen, Bo Tang, Shengbin Hou, Pengyu Wang, Haiying Deng, Zhiyu Li, Feiyu Xiong, Keming Mao, Peng Cheng, and Yi Luo
Proceedings of the 62nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics
- [A Sentiment Consolidation Framework for Meta-Review Generation](#) ACL'24
Miao Li, Jey Han Lau, Eduard Hovy
Proceedings of the 62nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics
- [Summarizing Multiple Documents with Conversational Structure for Meta-review Generation](#) EMNLP'23
Miao Li, Eduard Hovy, Jey Han Lau
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2023
- [DeltaScore: Fine-grained Story Evaluation with Perturbations](#) EMNLP'23
Zhuohan Xie, **Miao Li**, Trevor Cohn, Jey Han Lau
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2023
- [Compressed Heterogeneous Graph for Abstractive Multi-document Summarization](#) AAAI'23
Miao Li, Jianzhong Qi, Jey Han Lau
Proceedings of the 37th AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence
- [Personalized Abstractive Opinion Tagging](#) SIGIR'22
Mengxue Zhao, Yang Yang, **Miao Li**, Jingang Wang, Wei Wu, Pengjie Ren, Maarten de Rijke and Zhaochun Ren
Proceedings of the 45th International ACM SIGIR Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval
- [A Benchmark and Comprehensive Survey on Knowledge Graph Entity Alignment via Representation Learning](#) VLDBJ'22
Rui Zhang, Bayu Distiawan Trisedy, **Miao Li**, Yong Jiang, Jianzhong Qi
The International Journal on Very Large Data Bases
- [A Topic Augmented Text Generation Model: Joint Learning of Semantics and Structural Features](#) EMNLP'19
Hongyin Tang, **Miao Li**, Beihong Jin
Proceedings of the 2019 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing and the 9th International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing
- [A New Effective Neural Variational Model with Mixture-of-Gaussians Prior for Text Clustering](#) ICTAI'19
Miao Li, Hongyin Tang, Beihong Jin, Chengqing Zong
2019 IEEE 31st International Conference on Tools with Artificial Intelligence
- [Clustering Large-Scale Origin-Destination Pairs: A Case Study for Public Transit in Beijing](#) UIC'18
Miao Li, Beihong Jin, Hongyin Tang, Fusang Zhang
The 15th IEEE International Conference on Ubiquitous Intelligence and Computing

RESEARCH GRANTS

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- Google Gemini Academic Program Award, USD50,000.00 (GCP credits) 2026 - 2027

HONORS & AWARDS

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- Google Conference Scholarship, Google LLC Jan. 2023
 - AAAI-23 Student Scholarship, Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence Jan. 2023
 - National Scholarship for Graduates (top 2%), Education Ministry of China Nov. 2018
 - The First Prize Scholarship (top 8%), University of Chinese Academy of Sciences Oct. 2017 & 2018
 - Excellent Student Cadre, University of Chinese Academy of Sciences Jun. 2018 & 2019
 - Merit Student, University of Chinese Academy of Sciences Jun. 2018 & 2019
 - Outstanding Graduate, Northeastern University Jun. 2017
 - Outstanding Graduate Thesis Award (1/272), Northeastern University Jul. 2017
 - National Scholarship for Undergraduates (top 2%), Education Ministry of China Oct. 2016
 - The First Prize Scholarship (top 4%), Northeastern University Sep. 2015 & 2016
 - Excellent Student Cadre, Northeastern University Oct. 2015 & 2016

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

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- [Foundations of Natural Language Processing](#) (INFR10078) Course Tutor
AY 2025/2026 (Semester 2), The University of Edinburgh

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

- Journal reviewer: TKDE 2025
- Reviewer committee:
NeurIPS 2026, ICLR 2026, ACL 2023-2026, EMNLP 2023-2025, NAACL 2025, EACL 2023, NLP CC 2022-2023, WSDM 2022, SIGIR 2022, SIGKDD 2022, CIKM 2022
- Reviewer for ACL Rolling Review (2021 – Present)